



Fallingwater

Location Mill Run, Pennsylvania

Fallingwater is Frank Lloyd Wright's masterpiece and one of several supreme statements he made as an architect. Completed in 1938, it is a

private house built not just on the side of a rocky hillside but into it. The merging of building and site, each reinforcing the other, remains a tour de force. The house itself is unapologetically modern—sparse, spare, and angular—but it achieves the remarkable feat of seeming to grow from its site. Its most obvious technical

▲ TRAYLIKE BALCONIES OF THE FALLINGWATER HOUSE

achievement is the use of a series of apparently unsupported protruding horizontal exterior surfaces. Inside, the rooms flow seamlessly together. Its name comes from the river that cascades through and under the house.

San Simeon

Location California

Also known as Hearst Castle, San Simeon was built by architect Julia Morgan between 1919 and 1947 as a home for the newspaper magnate William Randolph Hearst. It is a lavish fantasy vision, on a gargantuan scale, of what a multimillionaire's palace should resemble. The rocky site overlooking the Pacific covers 390 square miles (1,000 square km), while the elaborately landscaped gardens extend over 549,000 square ft (51,000 square m). The style of the four principal buildings—the Casa Grande, where Hearst lived, and three guest houses—is broadly a fusion of Spanish Baroque and Moorish. The interiors are no less lavish and were largely conceived as suitable settings for Hearst's enormous art collection. They feature complete fireplaces shipped from Europe and Italian Renaissance ceilings.

Rockefeller Center

Location New York, New York

The Rockefeller Center is Manhattan's most celebrated complex of office blocks and corporate headquarters—a monument to the virtues of capitalism. The site, between 5th and 6th Avenues, covers some 1 million square ft (89,000 square m). It consists of 19 separate buildings linked by walkways and plazas, which are studded with statues. It is also home to an open-air ice rink. It was built in two stages: the first 14 buildings, all Art Deco in style, were constructed in 1931–1939; a further five buildings, in International Style—typically involving simple geometry and vast expanses of glass—were built in 1958–1974. The most famous building in the complex is Radio City Music Hall but the most commanding is that at its heart, the 850-ft- (260-m-) high, 66-storey RCA Tower.